

Wanting Echo Zhao

Malaysia / China | echozhao1998@gmail.com | +60 17 659 8207 | Deaf

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Summary

Deaf data science and UX professional who turns complex research and data into clear, human-centered solutions. Experience spans user research, business operations, accessibility, and visual communication in technology and academic settings. Currently pursuing a Master of Data Science at Monash University Malaysia. Led MediPort, winner of the Best Innovation Award at PwC's 2026 Inclusive Future Lab.

Work Experience

Woman Alliance Group — Research & Strategy Intern

Jan 2026 – Apr 2026

- Co-authored and supported the editorial development of *Symbiotic Workplace: 2026 China Inclusive Workplace Exemplary Case White Paper*, featuring 20 companies across six workplace-inclusion domains.
- Designed a new product framework and Figma-based promotional handbook, improving the clarity, usability, and consistency of internal knowledge assets.
- Researched ESG and ERG practices and synthesized findings into reports, presentation decks, and web content.

Clearwater — Research & Strategy Intern

Jul 2025

- Led research on DEI visibility, gender-equity practices, and employer-branding strategies across 18 global competitors, including Big Four, mid-tier, and boutique firms.
- Evaluated certification pathways (IIP, Good Work Standard, Best Companies) and produced actionable recommendations for improving external DEI storytelling.
- Authored a 30-page research handbook and delivered a 30-minute executive presentation outlining strategic recommendations for inclusive employer branding.
- Synthesized qualitative and quantitative findings into a practical framework for HR, People & Culture, and leadership teams.

China Education Symposium at Harvard University — Design Director

Nov 2024 – Nov 2025

- Directed the visual strategy for a global education symposium, creating clear and accessible communications for diverse audiences.
- Led cross-cultural design teams in producing cohesive digital and print materials.
- Developed narrative-driven presentations and handbooks using user-centered design principles to strengthen audience engagement.
- Collaborated with speakers, researchers, and organizers to ensure clarity, accessibility, and consistency across all outputs.

Apple Inc. — Operations Specialist | Business Expert | Specialist

Shenzhen, China · Oct 2021 – Apr 2024

Operations Specialist

- Led cross-functional projects that improved coordination and process efficiency across retail and back-office teams.
- Collected, analyzed, and reported operational metrics to support business decisions.
- Coordinated high-stakes business deliveries, including a 22-device launch-day fulfillment praised for accuracy and speed.

Business Expert

- Drove ¥420,653 in revenue through strategic customer engagement and data-driven communication.
- Conducted a rapid audit of 428 retail businesses, identifying new business opportunities and supporting market expansion.
- Organized a month-long business development initiative for 150 staff, increasing qualified leads by 30%.

Specialist

- Delivered accessible product guidance at each customer's pace, contributing to high CSAT scores.
- Supported new-hire onboarding and modeled customer-centered communication.

Diversity & Accessibility (DNA) Ambassador — Volunteer

- Co-led Diversity & Accessibility sessions for regional teams, promoting inclusive customer experiences.
- Educated staff on communication strategies for Deaf and diverse customers, strengthening service confidence.
- Contributed to internal initiatives fostering belonging, empathy, and accessibility awareness.

Education

Master of Data Science — Monash University Malaysia

Expected Graduation: October 2027

Bachelor's Degree in Statistics — Huaqiao University, China

Sep 2016 – Jul 2021

Certifications

Google UX Design Professional Certificate — Google, 2026

3 of 7 courses completed: Foundations of User Experience (UX) Design; Start the UX Design Process: Empathize, Define, and Ideate; Build Wireframes and Low-Fidelity Prototypes

Google Project Management Certificate — Google, 2024

AI for Everyone — DeepLearning.AI, 2024

Business English: Networking — University of Washington, 2026

Projects

MediPort — Patient-Led Care for NF2: UX Case Study

PwC Inclusive Future Lab • Project lead • Jun – Aug 2026 • **Best Innovation Award**

- Led a three-person team through a six-week UX project, managing the scope, schedule, risks, and final delivery.

- Designed and analyzed a bilingual survey (n=38), conducted four interviews, and facilitated workshops to turn research findings into personas, problem statements, and product priorities.
- Translated user insights into the information architecture and user flows, then co-designed the wireframes, design system, and 31-frame high-fidelity Figma prototype.
- Prioritized a testable consultation journey and moved unvalidated features to the roadmap, balancing user needs with technical feasibility and project constraints. Full case study: echozhao1998.github.io/mediport.

Personal Website & Digital Tools

- Designed and developed a personal website to showcase analytical writing, research interests, and professional work.
- Built web-based tools, including an image utility and an ASL fingerspelling learning prototype, to explore usability, rapid prototyping, and accessibility.

Analytical Writing & Research (Medium & Independent Work)

- Published essays on technology, organizations, accessibility, and personal experience, combining structured analysis with clear narrative writing.

Skills

- Data Analysis & Visualization (R, SQL, Tableau, Excel; developing Python through master's coursework)
- AI-Assisted Research, Analysis & Drafting
- UX Research & Synthesis (surveys, semi-structured interviews, personas, journey mapping, problem definition, accessibility review)
- Research & Analytical Writing
- Project & Stakeholder Coordination
- Digital Design & Storytelling (Figma, FigJam, Canva, Affinity Publisher)
- Accessibility & Inclusive Design
- Cross-cultural Communication

Languages

- Chinese (Native)
- English (Professional Working Proficiency) — TOEFL Reading 27, Writing 24 (Listening and Speaking waived under ETS accommodations for deaf test-takers)
- ASL/CSL/BIM (Basic Communication)

Additional Information

I am Deaf and communicate fluently in written Chinese and English. I work effectively in multilingual, collaborative environments using text-based communication, shared documents, and data-driven workflows. My lived experience strengthens my perspective on accessibility and helps me identify interaction and usability barriers that others may overlook.